

■ ABOUT WALKAWAY / SIÚIL LEAT

WalkAway / Siúil Leat is a violence prevention and awareness initiative working to reduce unprovoked violence in Ireland through violence prevention programmes, awareness campaigns and community engagement across schools, sporting organisations and communities.

We advocate for survivors of unprovoked attacks and bereaved families, promote legislative reform and develop positive role models to build safer communities across the island of Ireland.

■ OUR VISION

We envision an Ireland where:

- Violence prevention education is embedded within the school curriculum, sporting organisations and communities, with sport harnessed as a powerful vehicle for engagement and promotion of safer choices.
- Young people are equipped with the confidence and skills to walk away from confrontation, inspired by positive role models developed by WalkAway / Siúil Leat.
- Survivors and bereaved families are heard, represented and supported.
- Public understanding of impulsive violence and its consequences is greatly improved.
- Research, education and informed policy drive long-term cultural change in Ireland.

! Over 24,000 people were recorded as victims of assault, harassment and related violent offences in Ireland. Yet Ireland has no centralised data on how many of these relate to unprovoked fatal assaults. WalkAway / Siúil Leat is working to change that.

Source: Recorded Crime Victims 2024 (CSO, June 2025)

■ ABOUT THE CO-FOUNDERS

Sharon Lynn



Sharon Lynn is the sister of Martin Lynn, who died following an unprovoked assault after he exited a taxi outside his family home in Dublin, July 2023. Since Martin's death, Sharon has engaged in extensive policy work, media campaigns and advocacy relating to sentencing reform and victims rights in Ireland. Sharon's professional background in regulatory compliance, risk and governance informs WalkAway's approach to organisational development and policy reform.

Bryan Gallagher



Bryan Gallagher is the brother of Cian Gallagher, who died following a similar unprovoked assault as he was walking back to his accommodation in Co. Waterford, November 2022. Bryan has extensive experience in senior executive roles within the Health Service Executive and Non-Profit Organisations, with a proven track record in policy reform.

Together, Sharon & Bryan are founding WalkAway / Siúil Leat, an educational and awareness programme rooted in lived experience, designed to reach young people before violence ever happens.



WALKAWAY
— SIÚIL LEAT —
AWARENESS · EDUCATION · ADVOCACY · RESEARCH

CONTACT US

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OUR OBJECTIVES

WALKAWAY

Siúil Leat

OUR FOUR PILLARS

EDUCATION

Violence prevention programmes for school curriculum, sporting organisations and communities. A strong focus on early intervention to equip young people with the confidence and skills to walk away from confrontation.

AWARENESS

Improve public understanding of conflict escalation, impulsive and social violence and its consequences. Promoting a culture where walking away is a strength. High profile, positive role models will act as **Ambassadors** for the campaign.

ADVOCACY

Advocate for survivors of unprovoked attacks, bereaved families and meaningful legislative reform.

RESEARCH

Evidence-based approaches to violence prevention and community safety, informing our work across education, awareness and advocacy.

Real strength is knowing when to walk away.

HOW YOU CAN HELP

We are looking to collaborate with people or organisations who:

- believe, as we do, that real strength is knowing when to walk away
- have a voice that carries weight with the young people we most want to reach
- can help shape how a generation thinks about violence, long before harm is ever done

We would welcome the opportunity to tell you more about WalkAway / Siúil Leat and the vital role Ambassadors will play in bringing this national campaign to life.



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